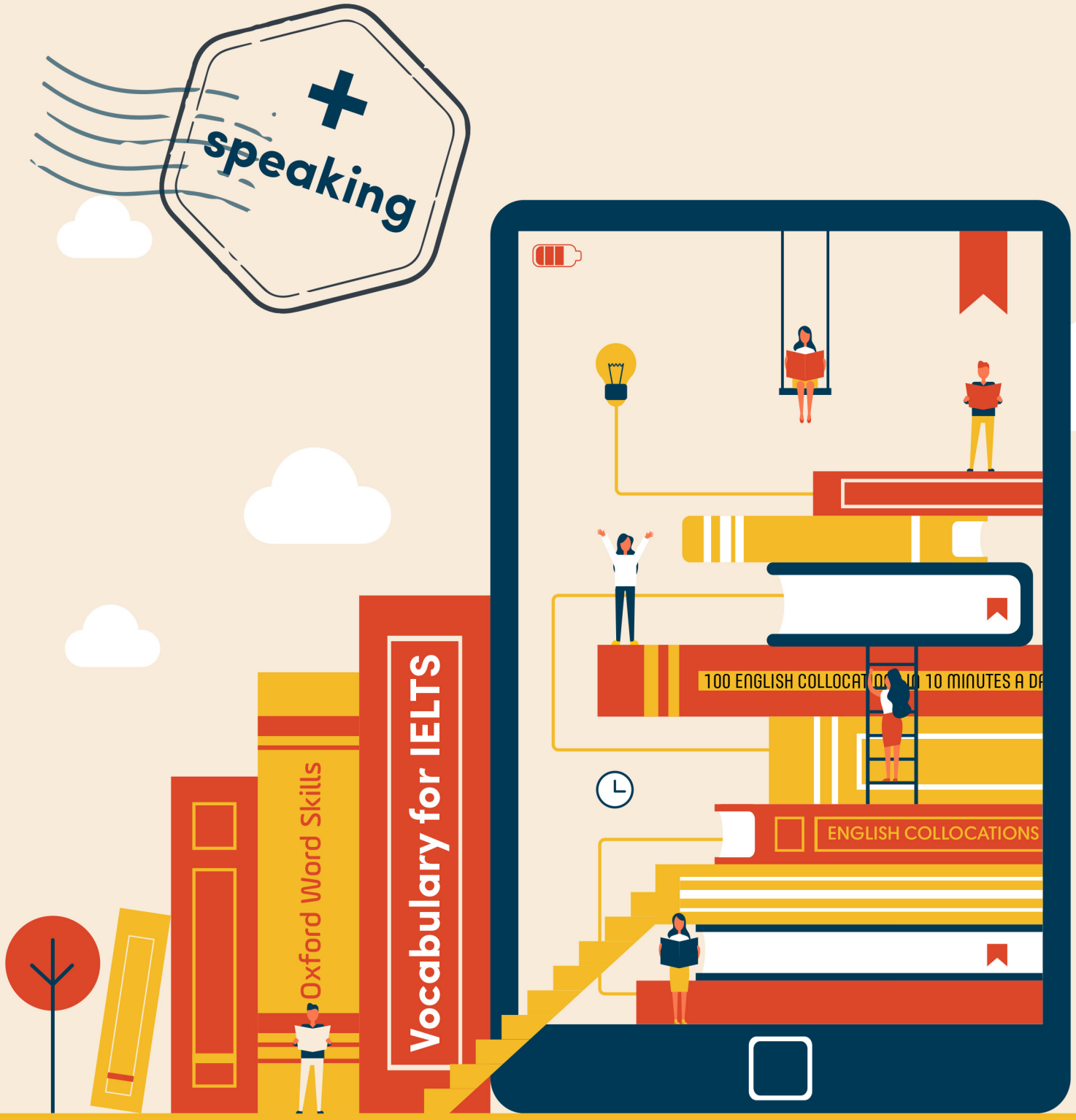
IELTS Up Words!

دوره لغات آیلتس

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Lesson 60: Sports

This is lesson sixty of IELTS Up Words! Can you believe it? Do you remember once I told you that, before you know it, it will be over? We are only a few more steps away to celebrate this well-deserved victory of yours! It was like running a marathon, wasn't it? Working your way up these lessons one step at a time got you where you are today. Bravo!

In this lesson, we are going to talk about sports. Some people develop a love-hate relationship with sports, meaning some days they love it and want to give a type of sports a try, while on other days, they just don't want to have anything to do with it.

I used to feel that way about yoga. Becoming a yogi had always been my dream; however, when I first started, it proved to be a real challenge to strike some yoga poses, and that struggle made me put off working out for a while. Of course, as I built my stamina and learned a few tricks, my attitude toward yoga improved to the point that not a day goes by without me breaking a sweat on my yoga mat.

When I was a teenager, I was more of a soccer fan. I used to watch soccer matches on TV and cheer for my favorite team, Manchester United. They were a great team and just like the rest of the fanbase, I was in love with that team's striker, Cristiano Ronaldo. As I said, he played as a striker in that team, but he would also take up the role of a midfielder when needed. He won Manchester United many championships, and I respect him for his display of sportsmanship.

Another favorite soccer player of mine is Alireza Beiranvand, Iran's goalkeeper, that once saved Ronaldo's penalty. I remember that day vividly. It was a World Cup match between Iran and Portugal, and in that game, Portugal was awarded a penalty. Iran was ready to go to pieces and accept defeat, but after Ronaldo missed that penalty, the crowd went wild. I guess we all screamed at the top of our lungs. Haha.

When talking about sports, make sure to use the right verb. We typically use “play” for team sports, “do” for some individual sports, and “go” for those activities ending in -ing.

do	gymnastics, weightlifting, aerobics, wrestling, archery, athletics
play	hockey, football, chess, golf, billiards
go	skiing, surfing, climbing, hiking, jogging, sailing, cycling

The topic of sports is a recurring one on all three parts of IELTS speaking, so learn a few related words and practice talking about your favorite sports, the most popular sports in your country, mental sports, and the future of sports. Below are three questions for you to practice with.

- Do you often watch sports on TV?
- Do you think the types of sports that are popular will change in the future?
- Why do some people enjoy sports more than others?

Speaking Tip

Fill or Feel?

This is another big pronunciation mistake that Iranian learners usually make.

Making this mistake changes the meaning of words and loses you the mark.

The phonetic symbol for the long sound that you hear is /i:/ and for the short sound that you hear /I/.

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
a well-deserved victory	a victory that is justly and rightly earned	یک پیروزی شایسته و به‌حق	related: deserve to win narrowly defeated/ beaten
running a marathon	a long-distance running race	دویدن در یک مسابقهٔ ماراتن	a walkathon; a walking marathon
yogi	a person who is proficient in yoga	یوگی؛ کسی که در یوگا مهارت دارد	Yoga yoga mat
it proved to be a real challenge	it turned out to be a real challenge	مشخص شد که یک چالش بزرگ است	I found it quite challenging
to strike a yoga pose	to stand or sit with your body in a particular position during a yoga exercise	ژست یوگا گرفتن	related: to keep your balance
to put off working out	to decide or arrange to delay the workout until a later time or date	به‌تعویق انداختن تمرین ورزشی	to postpone/ suspend to procrastinate
to break a sweat	to start sweating because you are making an effort; exert oneself physically	عرق‌ریختن حین انجام یک فعالیت فیزیکی	sweaty hands
soccer	a game played by two teams of eleven players with a round ball	فوتبال	Football field a draw to tackle an opponent
a soccer fan	someone who admires and supports soccer	یک طرفدار فوتبال	compare spectator and commentator

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
match	a contest in which people or teams compete against each other in a particular sport	مسابقه	competition; game
to cheer for a team	to direct loud shouts of approval or encouragement toward a team	تشویق کردن یک تیم ورزشی	opposite: to boo a team
fanbase	a group of fans for a particular sport or team	گروهی از طرفداران یک ورزش یا تیم خاص	
striker	a player in a game, such as football, whose main purpose is to try to score goals	مهاجم	goalkeeper, midfielder, defender, forward, winger
championship	a high-level competition to decide who is the best	مسابقهٔ قهرمانی	champion
display of sportsmanship	showing fair and generous behavior or treatment of others	نشان‌دادن اخلاق ورزشکاری	related: doping to fail a drug test
to be awarded a penalty	an advantage given in some sports to a team or player when the opposing team or player breaks a rule	دریافت پنالتی	to miss; save; take a penalty
to go to pieces	to be so nervous or worried that you cannot behave in a sensible way	کنترل خود را ازدست‌دادن	to break down; to be overcome
do weightlifting	lift heavy objects either as a sport or for exercise	وزنه‌برداری	weightlifter related: biceps

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
do archery	the art or sport of shooting arrows	تیراندازی با کمان	archer; bowman
do athletics	a particular group of sports in which people compete, including running, jumping, and throwing	ورزش‌های رقابتی	athlete (noun) atheltic (adjective)
go cycling	the act or sport of riding or traveling by bicycle	دوچرخه‌سواری	bicycle race
mental sports	a competition that is based on a particular type of intellectual ability as opposed to physical exercise	ورزش‌های ذهنی	mind sports

other words/ structures	meaning	translation	other structures
to develop a love-hate relationship with something	to have strong feelings about something that are a mixture of love and hate	داشتن رابطهٔ توام با عشق و تنفّر نسبت به چیزی	a love-hate thing
they don't want to have anything to do with it	they don't want any involvement with it in any way (used in negative statements)	نمی‌خواهند هیچ کاری با آن داشته باشند	nothing (further) to do with something example: After the last time, we want nothing further to do with them.
struggle	to experience difficulty and make a really great effort to do something	دست‌وپنجه‌نرم‌کردن؛ کشمکش	
the crowd went wild	the crowd (spectators) became very noisy and excited	جمعیت(به‌طورناگهانی) هیجان‌زده شد	go crazy; go nuts (informal)
we all screamed at the top of our lungs	we all screamed as loudly as possible	تا جایی که می‌توانستیم داد زدیم	
a recurring topic	a topic that occurs repeatedly	یک موضوع تکرارشونده	recurrent; repetitive



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